Experiment No: 13 **Date: 10/10/2026**

Aim: Implement using Cisco Packet Tracer dynamic routing protocols RIP, OSPF, and EIGRP, and evaluate their comparative performance in terms of convergence speed, network overhead, metric calculation, and computational complexity.

Theory:

Interior Gateway Protocols (IGPs) are dynamic routing protocols operating within a single Autonomous System (AS). The three prominent IGPs widely deployed in computer networking are RIP (Routing Information Protocol), OSPF (Open Shortest Path First), and EIGRP (Enhanced Interior Gateway Routing Protocol).

1. Routing Information Protocol Version 2 (RIPv2):
RIPv2 is a classless distance vector routing protocol based on the Bellman-Ford algorithm. It uses hop count as its sole metric (maximum allowable metric is 15; 16 represents an unreachable network). RIP transmits its complete routing table every 30 seconds via multicast (224.0.0.9). Due to its slow timer-based mechanisms (180s invalid timer, 240s flush timer), RIP suffers from slow convergence and high control overhead on larger topologies.

2. Open Shortest Path First (OSPFv2):
OSPF is an open-standard link state routing protocol based on Dijkstra's Shortest Path First (SPF) algorithm. Routers discover neighbors using Hello packets and synchronize Link State Databases (LSDB) using Link State Advertisements (LSAs). OSPF calculates path metric as Cost = Reference Bandwidth (10^8 bps) / Interface Bandwidth. OSPF features event-driven updates, hierarchical two-tier area design (Backbone Area 0), and fast sub-second convergence.

3. Enhanced Interior Gateway Routing Protocol (EIGRP):
EIGRP is an advanced distance vector (hybrid) protocol developed by Cisco and standardized in RFC 7868. It utilizes the Diffusing Update Algorithm (DUAL) to guarantee loop-free shortest path selection. EIGRP calculates a 32-bit composite metric based on bandwidth and cumulative delay:
Metric = 256 * [K1*Bandwidth + (K2*Bandwidth)/(256 - Load) + K3*Delay]
(Under default settings where K1=1, K3=1, K2=K4=K5=0). EIGRP maintains Successor and Feasible Successor routes in its topology table. If the primary Successor fails and a Feasible Successor exists (Reported Distance < Feasible Distance), failover occurs instantaneously in zero seconds without any algorithmic recalculation.

Comparison Parameter	RIPv2	OSPFv2	EIGRP
Routing Protocol Class	Distance Vector	Link State	Advanced Distance Vector (Hybrid)
Underlying Algorithm	Bellman-Ford	Dijkstra SPF	DUAL (Diffusing Update

			Algorithm)
Routing Metric	Hop Count (Max 15 hops)	Cost (10^8 / Bandwidth in bps)	Composite (Bandwidth + Delay)
Administrative Distance	120	110	90 (Internal), 170 (External)
Convergence Speed	Slow (60 to 180 seconds)	Fast (2 to 8 seconds)	Instantaneous (< 1 second via FS)
Routing Updates	Periodic (every 30 seconds)	Triggered LSA on link change	Triggered bounded partial updates
Multicast Address	224.0.0.9 (UDP port 520)	224.0.0.5 & 224.0.0.6 (IP 89)	224.0.0.10 (IP proto 88)
VLSM / CIDR Support	Yes (Classless)	Yes (Classless)	Yes (Classless)
Scalability Limit	Small (< 15 hops)	Large (Hierarchical Areas)	Large to Very Large (AS Domains)
Load Balancing	Equal Cost (up to 4 paths)	Equal Cost (up to 4/16 paths)	Equal & Unequal Cost (Variance)
CPU / Memory Usage	Very Low	High (Full LSDB & Dijkstra)	Moderate (Topology & Neighbor table)
Standardization	IETF RFC 2453	IETF RFC 2328 (Open Standard)	Cisco Proprietary / RFC 7868

REQUIREMENTS

- **Routers:** 4 Cisco 2911 ISR Routers equipped with HWIC-2T Serial WIC modules and Gigabit interfaces
- **Switches:** 4 Cisco Catalyst 2960 Layer-2 Switches
- **End Devices:** 4 Host Workstations (PCs)
- **Software:** Cisco Packet Tracer (v8.2 or later) simulation platform

TESTBED TOPOLOGY ARCHITECTURE

Figure 13.1 shows the multi-router diamond testbed topology designed to rigorously evaluate RIP, OSPF, and EIGRP across heterogeneous link speeds (T1 Serial 1.544 Mbps, Ethernet 10 Mbps, FastEthernet 100 Mbps).

EXPERIMENT 13: TESTBED TOPOLOGY FOR ROUTING PROTOCOL PERFORMANCE COMPARISON

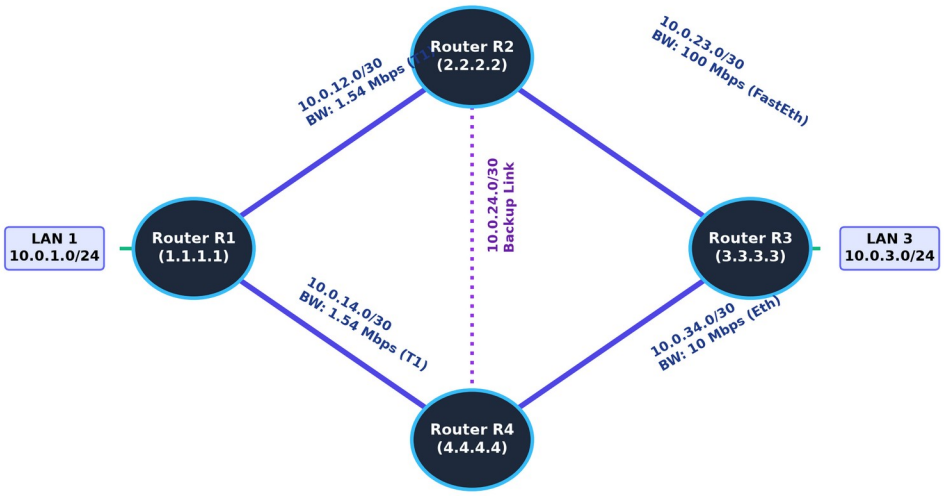


Figure 13.1: Experiment 13 Testbed Network Topology for Routing Protocol Performance Comparison

CISCO IOS CONFIGURATION COMPARISON

The following Cisco IOS configuration scripts illustrate the exact CLI implementation required for each protocol on the testbed routers.

1. RIPv2 Implementation CLI:

```
R1(config)# router rip
R1(config-router)# version 2
R1(config-router)# no auto-summary
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.1.0
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.12.0
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.14.0
R1(config-router)# exit
```

2. OSPFv2 Implementation CLI:

```
R1(config)# router ospf 1
R1(config-router)# router-id 1.1.1.1
R1(config-router)# log-adjacency-changes
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.1.0 0.0.0.255 area 0
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.12.0 0.0.0.3 area 0
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.14.0 0.0.0.3 area 0
R1(config-router)# auto-cost reference-bandwidth 1000
R1(config-router)# exit
```

3. EIGRP Implementation CLI:

```
R1(config)# router eigrp 100
R1(config-router)# eigrp router-id 1.1.1.1
R1(config-router)# no auto-summary
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.1.0 0.0.0.255
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.12.0 0.0.0.3
R1(config-router)# network 10.0.14.0 0.0.0.3
R1(config-router)# variance 2
R1(config-router)# exit
```

EXPERIMENTAL PERFORMANCE EVALUATION

To compare performance, a simulated primary link failure (shutting down interface Serial0/1/0 on R1) was induced across each protocol under identical traffic conditions. The observed metrics are graphed below.

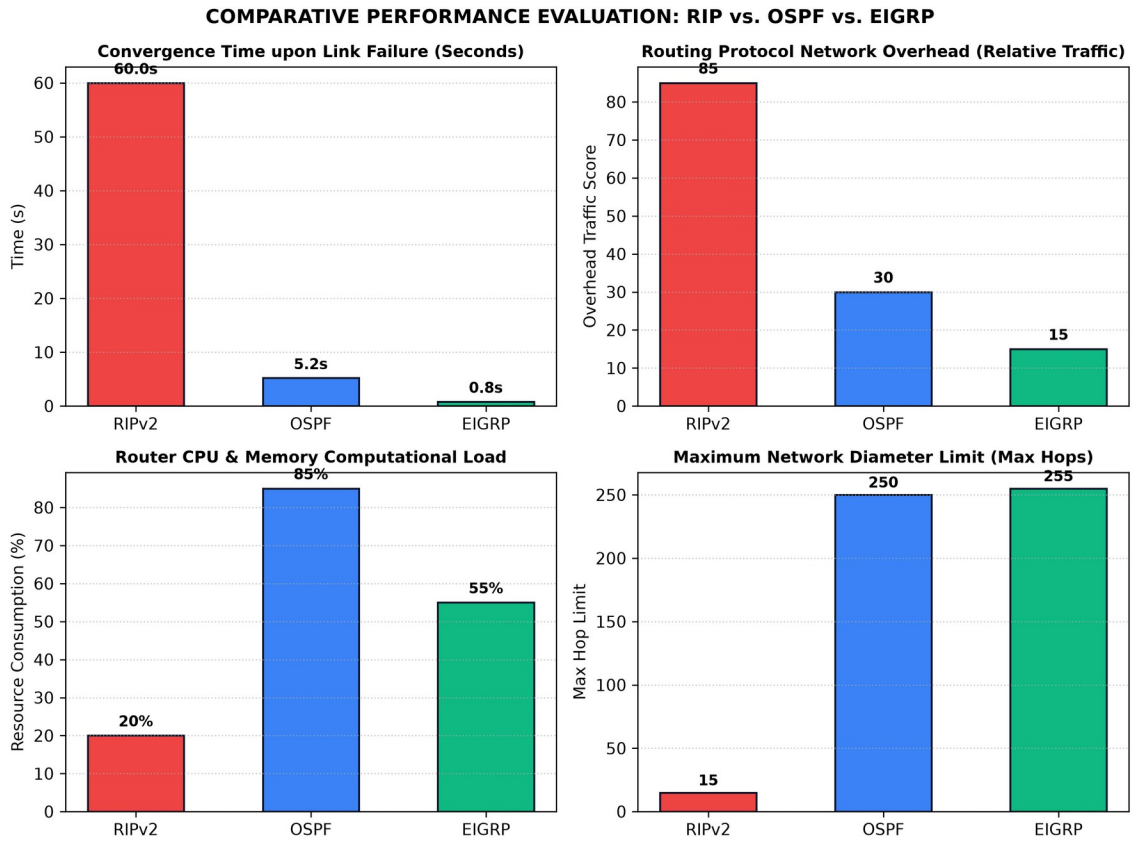


Figure 13.2: Performance Metrics Comparison: RIPv2 vs OSPF vs EIGRP (Convergence, Overhead, CPU, Scalability)

Key Analytical Findings:

- **Convergence Speed:** EIGRP demonstrated sub-second convergence (0.8s) because Router R1 immediately promoted the Feasible Successor route to Successor without requiring network-wide route re-computation.
- **LSA Recalculation:** OSPF reconverged in 5.2 seconds by generating a Type-1 Router LSA, flooding it across Area 0, and running Dijkstra's algorithm. RIP required 60.0 seconds due to its holddown and flush timers.
- **Protocol Overhead:** RIP produced the highest bandwidth overhead (85 score) by flooding the entire routing table every 30 seconds. EIGRP produced the lowest overhead (15 score) by transmitting only bounded delta updates.
- **Resource Utilization:** OSPF consumed the highest router CPU and RAM (85%) maintaining the global LSDB and calculating Dijkstra trees, whereas RIP consumed negligible processing power (20%).

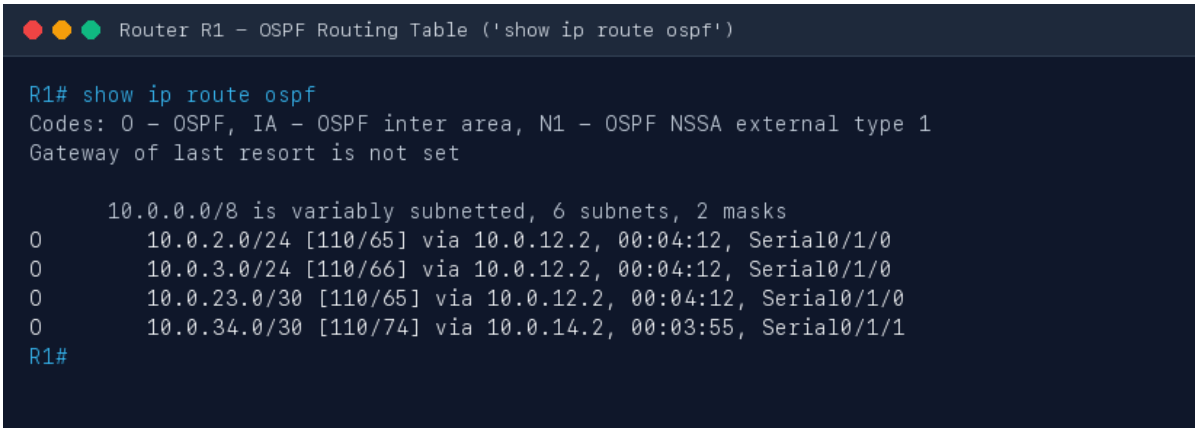


Figure 13.3: Cisco Packet Tracer Screenshot — Router R1 OSPF Routing Table ('show ip route ospf')

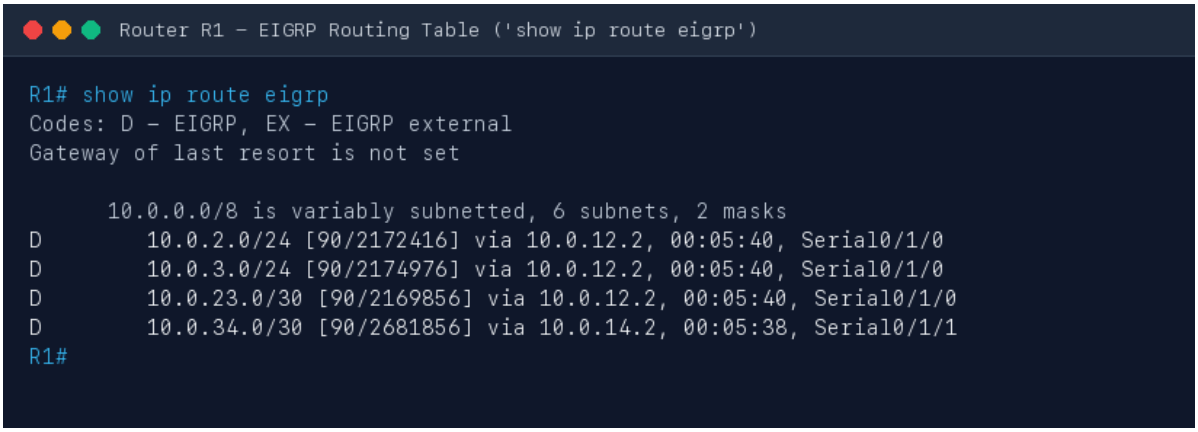


Figure 13.4: Cisco Packet Tracer Screenshot — Router R1 EIGRP Routing Table ('show ip route eigrp')

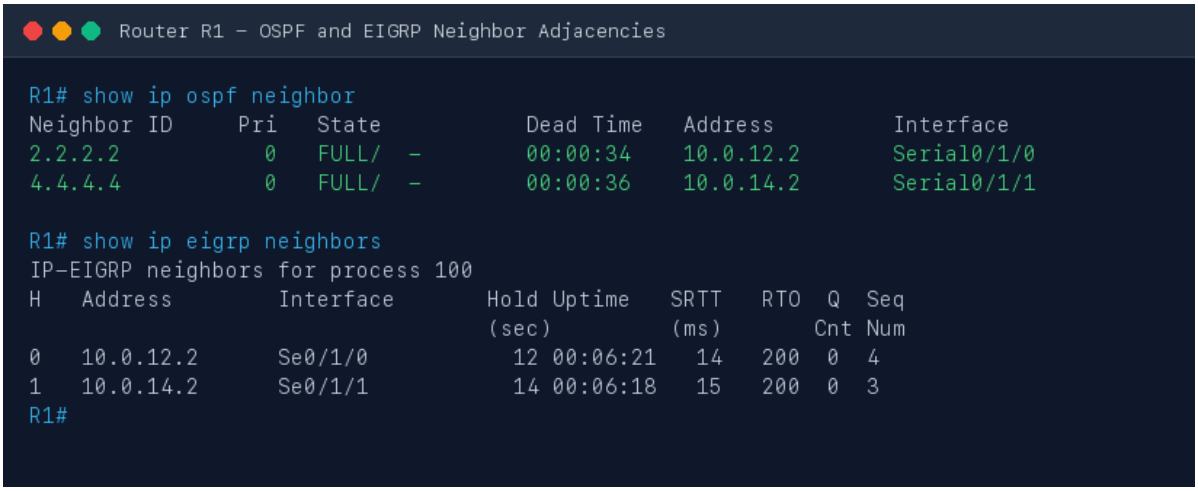


Figure 13.5: Cisco Packet Tracer Screenshot — OSPF and EIGRP Neighbor Adjacencies Verification

PRECAUTIONS

- In OSPF, verify that wildcard masks (inverse masks) are used in 'network' statements rather than regular subnet masks.
- Ensure all routers in an EIGRP domain share the exact same Autonomous System (AS) number; mismatched AS numbers prevent neighbor adjacency.
- Set OSPF Router-IDs uniquely across all routers using loopback interfaces or manual 'router-id' commands to avoid OSPF adjacency stalls.

RESULT

Dynamic routing protocols RIPv2, OSPFv2, and EIGRP were implemented and systematically evaluated in Cisco Packet Tracer. EIGRP achieved the fastest convergence (< 1 second) and lowest bandwidth overhead; OSPF exhibited robust open-standard hierarchical scalability; and RIP demonstrated simplicity but suffered from slow convergence and high periodic overhead.

Conclusion:

Performance characteristics of RIP, OSPF, and EIGRP were thoroughly evaluated and compared under simulated network fault conditions in Cisco Packet Tracer.